

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

Exercise: Setting some goals

With that in mind, I'd like you to carefully consider up to three goals that you'd like to start working on now – one short term, one long term and perhaps one medium term. Write them down. You might also like to share these with a friend or your accountability buddy as a declaration of your faith in your ability to achieve them, and a way to ensure that you are answerable for taking actions that will guide you towards them.

Set a reminder or calendar entry to make sure that you check in on your goals at regular intervals, to make sure that you're making progress and moving towards them, but also to make sure that your goals are still right for your circumstances. Once a month, or even every three months is a good rule of thumb – checking them too frequently will only frustrate you and narrow your vision.

Aligning your financial plans with your personal values

An often-overlooked element of financial wellbeing is that most of us are very aware of the fact that our money has a life beyond its brief time within our possession, and that where we direct it actually matters. Some of the spending guilt that sits within us may well come from a place of regretting who we have given our money to, as well as what we received